



MONTHLY UPDATE

Equatorial Guinea: monthly update, July 2026

Edition of 2026-08-21 · 25 systems and instruments tracked, 6 of them not held

Developments recorded from artefacts published between 2026-07-01 and 2026-08-21 — July 2026 carried forward to the date of issue, so the report holds the nightly catch to the day it was cut. Sections follow the status report.

Summary of the month

July 2026 was a month of institutional moves rather than delivery. The government [adopted a consolidated action plan](#) of 35 strategic objectives on 31 July that names recovering the .GQ domain as a sovereignty measure, [signed the Malabo Convention](#) on 28 July, [halted the TELGESA merger](#) pending an audit, and [authorised Starlink offshore](#) for American oil companies only.

Two things carried past the month's close. On 5 August the [Treasury Single Account committee](#) approved a five-phase roadmap, and on 7 August a [State Secretariat for Artificial Intelligence](#) was taken by the outgoing head of the state telecoms infrastructure operator.

Infrastructure

Connectivity

GETESA signed a [network contract with Huawei](#) on 9 July 2026 covering the modernisation the operator set out in May — 5G, eSIM, public Wi-Fi and fibre reactivation. The [independent outlet Radio Macuto](#) reported the arrangement on 15 July as a rescue of GETESA alongside the creation of TELGESA, and criticised the procurement as opaque.

At a working session on 22 July with the commission examining state-participation companies, Vice-President Nguema Obiang Mangué [ordered an audit of GECOMSA](#) — its financial position, the value of its assets and liabilities and its outstanding debts — before the definitive merger agreement with Loita Group creating TELGESA is signed.

The Minister of Transport, Posts and New Information and Communication Technologies [signed a temporary Starlink authorisation](#) on 28 July at a ceremony in the Palacio del Pueblo, permitting North American companies to use the service for operations on the high seas within jurisdictional waters, and handed it to the Minister of Hydrocarbons with the oil companies operating in the country present. A negotiating commission meeting the same day [heard that type-approval and the competences of the company and the regulator ORTEL remain undefined](#); a first phase serves public bodies, airport terminals and selected companies, and extension to individual subscribers is conditional on the negotiations concluding, which the executive justifies on security grounds.

The same ministry published [terms of reference for a public tender](#) on 29 July for a full technical diagnostic of existing digital terrestrial television infrastructure and its regularisation, rehabilitation, commissioning and operational transfer. It is Treasury-financed, and no contract value, tender deadline or switchover date is stated.

The ministry put a six-month connectivity plan to the Prime Minister on 15 July. It [names 2G and 4G coverage to 85% through 34 new towers in Annobón and the interior, a Roaming Cero arrangement with Cameroon, Gabon, Chad and the Central African Republic, and a national digital postcode system](#). No budget, contract or delivery date accompanies any of the three, and the consolidated action plan they sit in was adopted on 31 July unfinanced, going first to the interministerial council and then to the Council of Ministers, which decides what is recorded and funded.

Cybersecurity

Ley 7/2024 of 23 December 2024 creates ANCIC, the National Cybersecurity and Critical Infrastructure Agency, under the Presidency, stated to draw on the Budapest and Malabo conventions.

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

The national interoperability framework the World Bank named as absent in 2024 is still absent, and August put a cost on that. At the National Development Agency's directorship handover on 7 August, its outgoing Inspector General [named limited data-sharing by line ministries as the agency's main obstacle](#) to monitoring delivery against the National Sustainable Development Strategy. The agency is the body meant to see across government, and it is describing itself as unable to.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

The Comité Nacional de la Cuenta Única del Tesoro, chaired by the prime minister, [approved a work programme and institutional roadmap](#) at the Presidency on 5 August 2026. The general census of all state bank accounts is complete; the new financial-management model will be built on AMS/X and SINTAG, both already used by the BEAC, interconnected with the Treasury's public-finance systems; and implementation runs in five phases with entry into production in the first quarter of 2027. No cost, implementing agency or supplier is stated.

A GITGE study of the ministries, [reported on 2 July](#), put interoperability at about 15%, big data at about 21% and data analysis at about 10%. Against that measure, the [Public Administration Institute's launch of its first institutional website on 10 August](#) — carrying its training offer, calls for applications and publications — is a small step and a fair measure of the starting point.

National statistics

INEGE opened a three-day validation workshop on 27 July at the Ministry of Finance, Budgets and National Planning on the project document, resource-mobilisation advocacy strategy and social-communication strategy for the [fifth population census and the first agricultural census](#), with UNFPA and FAO technical support and around fifty representatives of ministries, the National Assembly, the UN system, the AfDB, the World Bank, WHO and CEMAC. Decree 25/2025 of 3 March 2025 authorises both operations; the last population census was in 2015.

Census preparation was validated a second time in four weeks without an enumeration date being set. The scientific committee [validated the project document, the resource-mobilisation strategy and the communication strategy for the fifth population and housing census and the first agricultural census](#), reading into the record the 2025 decree ordering both operations and the resolution that created the committees. The project document is stated to fix objectives, methodology, timetable and the agricultural sample size; none of it is published, and neither is a date on which anyone will be counted.

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

The 2024 social media and computer crime law is [in force with its provisions reported in rollout from July, including a bar on social-media access for under-fourteens without parental authorisation](#); the full text is not held. Alongside it the information minister [presented a press-law reform bill on 6 August regulating digital media and cable television for the first time](#), now under committee review with no adoption date and no bill text published. The Chamber of Deputies' own account of the sitting shows it was not presented alone: [a separate Copyright and Related Rights bill went to the chamber the same day](#), implementing Equatorial Guinea's 1997 Berne Convention accession and its 2015 Bangui Agreement obligations under OAPI, so the copyright provisions are a companion instrument rather than part of the audiovisual bill.

Strategies, plans and policies

The ministry's second extraordinary directive council [adopted a consolidated July–December 2026 action plan](#) of 35 strategic objectives under three national priorities, one of them restoring sovereignty over the national digital space including the .GQ domain. Named measures include a Comisión Nacional de Negociación to recover the domain and a requirement that frequency licence fees and registration charges be paid in full into the Public Treasury. The plan goes to the interministerial council and then to the Council of Ministers, which decides which measures are recorded and funded.

The commission on state-participation companies [heard candidates on 29 July](#) for director-general and deputy posts at GITGE, ANDEGE, INSESO and Gepetrol Servicios against stated criteria, with appointments provisional for six months.

Regional collaboration

The Minister of Foreign Affairs [signed the Malabo Convention at Addis Ababa on 28 July 2026](#), on the margins of the 49th Ordinary Session of the Executive Council. The AU status list as of 2 February 2026 recorded no signature, no ratification and no deposit for Equatorial Guinea, so the Chamber of Deputies' vote of 25 March 2026 was a domestic authorisation to ratify taken before the country was a signatory; no instrument of ratification is on file.

Standards

A quality-of-service regulation of 2018 is [confirmed in force on the regulator's own legislation index](#). Only its title and date are held, not its text; the same index lists an inspection and sanctions regulation of 2020 and a broadband-market update of February 2026, neither of which the ledger carries as a row.

Open data

[EITI data collection for the 2024 report](#) opened at Malabo on 30 July as the last outstanding measure before validation of the IMF Staff-Monitored Programme.

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

AI

On 7 August 2026 Óscar Ondo Ngomo left the director-generalship of GITGE, which he had held for thirteen years, to become [Secretary of State charged with artificial intelligence](#) at the Ministry of Transport, Telecommunications and Civil Aviation; the account describes the portfolio as newly named at that level.

ICT Industry

Salvador Nguema Funtam took over at GITGE with a new deputy, the outcome of the July selection process.

The consultancy AVANTE brought public institutions, banks and technology firms to the Hotel Anda China in Malabo on 22 July with the backing of the national development agency ANDGE. Panellists included the ministry's director-general for artificial intelligence, GITGE's technical director and BANGE's deputy head of digital and electronic banking.

The base's first record of a national e-commerce platform arrived on 14 August, when the economy ministry and [SelBa24 met to organise the country's first e-commerce and digital-payments seminar-workshop](#), to run simultaneously in Malabo and Bata between September and October and to train SMEs, traders and farmers to open and run free online stores on the platform. Nothing about SelBa24 itself — its ownership, merchant count, transaction volume or launch date — is stated.

Inclusion and capacity

Research institutions

[GITGE's deputy director-general presented doctoral findings](#) at the AVANTE forum on 22 July on big data, interoperability and digital identity in the public administration, arguing that the constraint is structural gaps and elapsed time rather than technology.

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